



Presented by The High End



CARDBOARD ROCKET SHIP

Life-Size Sit-In Rocket — Your Kid Is the Astronaut

Build a rocket your kid stands inside. Stars, flames, and blastoff sounds extra.

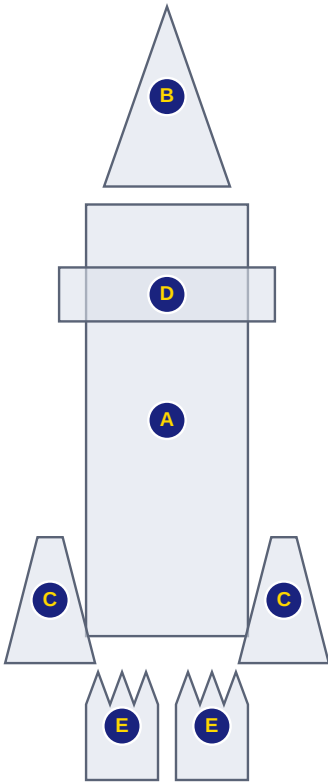
AGES 3–10	BOXES 2–3 Large Boxes	TIME 1–2 Hours	DIFF Beginner *	PIECES 5 pcs
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CARDBOARD NEEDED:
2–3 Large Boxes (at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm) each)

MISSION GOAL:
Build a standing rocket ship the child stands inside: nose cone, 4 fins, cockpit cut-out, bold flames at base.

HOW IT ALL GOES TOGETHER — CARDBOARD ROCKET SHIP

The finished build, side view, with every part in the place the steps put it and the letter from its own cut-template page. Parts are drawn at their real size relative to each other, so if a letter is on this picture there is a page for it in this file. Pieces that roll into a tube are shown rolled, not laid flat.



EVERY PART IN THIS BUILD

A	ROCKET BODY (FULL BOX) 18" × 48" (46 × 122 cm)	CUT ×1	B	NOSE CONE TRIANGLE 14" × 20" (36 × 51 cm)	CUT ×4
C	FIN 10" × 14" (25 × 36 cm)	CUT ×4	D	COCKPIT RING STRIP 24" × 6" (61 × 15 cm)	CUT ×3
E	FLAME PANEL 8" × 12" (20 × 30 cm)	CUT ×4			

BUILD SEQUENCE — WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER EACH STEP

Each picture is the build once that step is finished. The part you just added is the ORANGE one. Grey is what was already there. Work down the page and yours should look like each picture in turn.

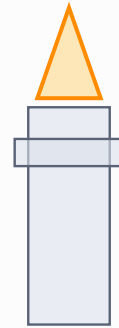
1 SET UP THE BODY



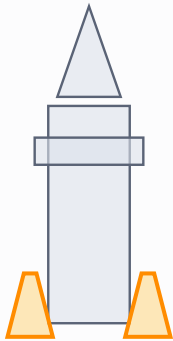
2 CUT THE COCKPIT OPENING



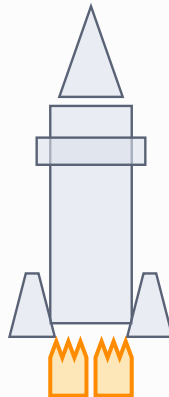
3 BUILD THE NOSE CONE



5 ATTACH THE FINS



6 ADD FLAMES





ROCKET BODY (FULL BOX)

18" x 48" (46 x 122 cm) | Cut x1

CUT
x1

ROCKET BODY (FULL BOX)

x1

0"4"8"12"16"

4"8"12"16"20"24"28"32"36"40"44"

COCKPIT OPENING — CUT OUT
(adult only)

18" x 48" (46 x 122 cm)

Top closed, bottom open — child stands inside

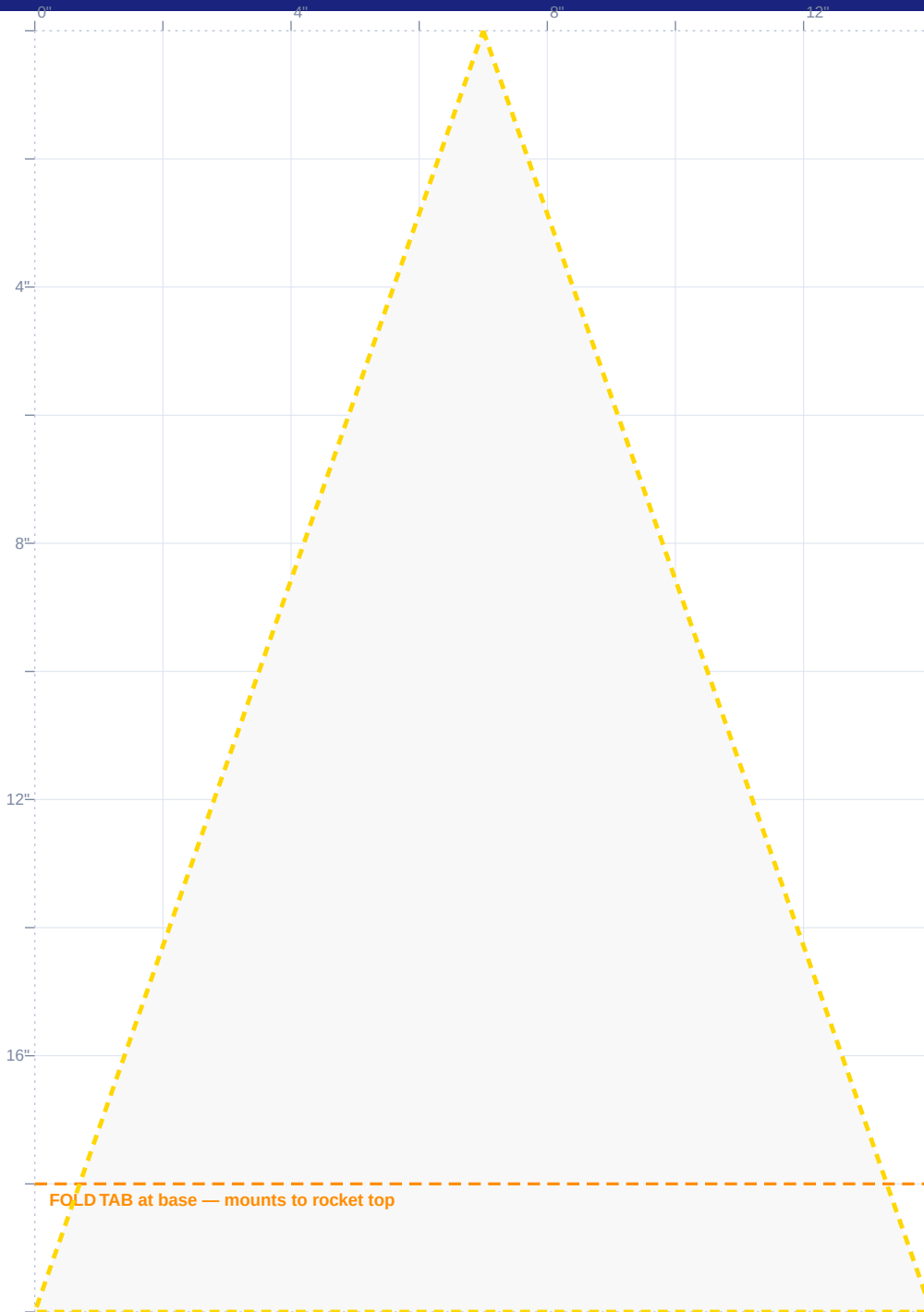
MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

CUT OUT — cut along the red dashes (an orange side is a fold)

NOTE: Top closed, bottom open — child stands inside

NOSE CONE TRIANGLE

x4

**HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:**

Mark the centre of the top edge. Draw straight lines from there to both bottom corners.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

14" × 20" (36 × 51 cm)

Triangle — full-width base, point at the top

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: All 4 identical — tape into cone



FIN

10" × 14" (25 × 36 cm) | Cut ×4

CUT
x4

FIN

x4

0" 4" 8"

4"

8"

12"

FOLD 2" TAB at base — mounting tab. Tape to rocket bottom.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:
Mark 3.6" in from each TOP corner. Draw straight lines from those marks down to the bottom corners.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

10" × 14" (25 × 36 cm)
Swept fin — wide base, narrow angled top

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.	FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line
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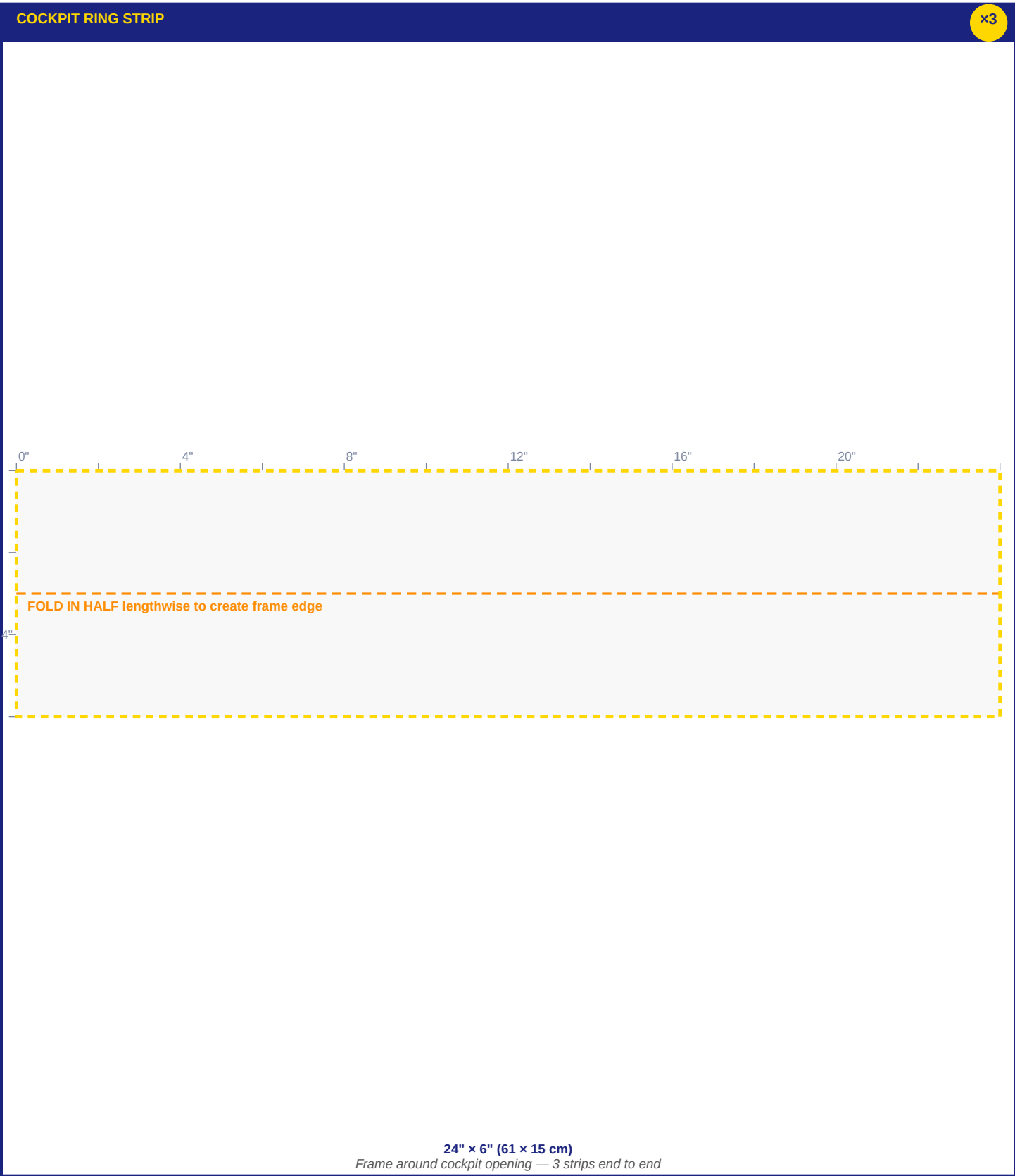
NOTE: Wide base, angled point — mount 90° apart



COCKPIT RING STRIP

24" × 6" (61 × 15 cm) | Cut ×3

CUT
x3



MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Frame around cockpit opening — 3 strips end to end

E

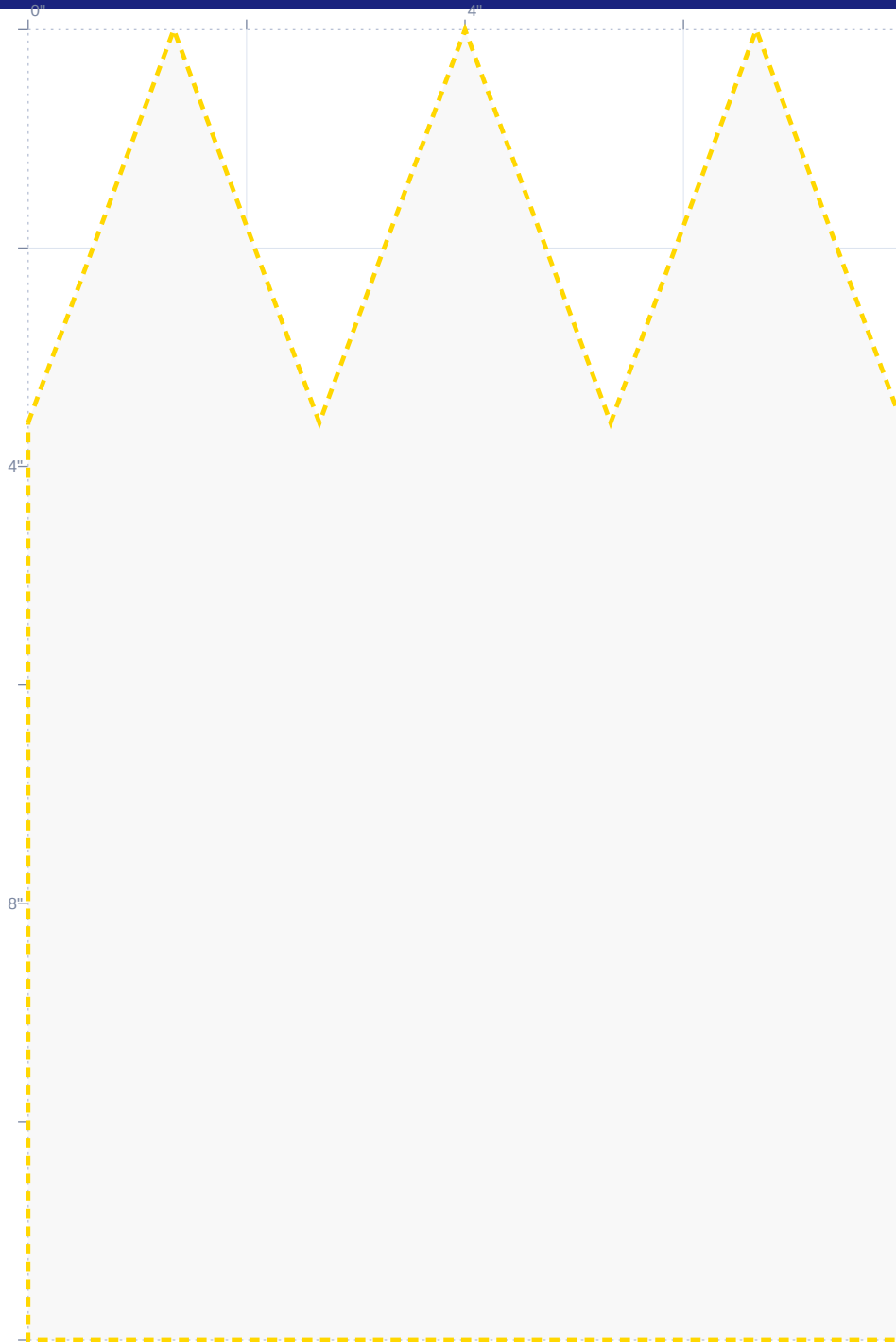
FLAME PANEL

8" × 12" (20 × 30 cm) | Cut ×4

CUT
x4

FLAME PANEL

x4

**HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:**

Mark 3 points about 2.7" apart along the top edge and cut a triangle 3.6" deep at each, like flames.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

8" × 12" (20 × 30 cm)*Flame tips — pointed along the top edge***MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:**

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

NOTE: Jagged top edge — paint red/orange/yellow

WHAT YOU NEED — CARDBOARD ROCKET SHIP

CARDBOARD PIECES — 5 TOTAL (2–3 Large Boxes (at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm) each))

×1 Rocket Body (full box)
18" × 48" *Top closed, bottom open — child stands inside*

×4 Nose Cone Triangle
14" × 20" *All 4 identical — tape into cone*

×4 Fin
10" × 14" *Wide base, angled point — mount 90° apart*

×3 Cockpit Ring Strip
24" × 6" *Frame around cockpit opening — 3 strips end to end*

×4 Flame Panel
8" × 12" *Jagged top edge — paint red/orange/yellow*

TOOLS & SUPPLIES

+ 2–3 large cardboard boxes (refrigerator/appliance size ideal)

+ Box cutter — ADULT USE ONLY

+ Packing tape

+ Yellow, red, orange markers or paint

+ Gold or silver star stickers OR draw with marker

+ Black marker for details

FUN FACT!

The Saturn V rocket was 363 feet tall. Yours is 4 feet. Per foot, yours cost way less to build.

CHALLENGE!

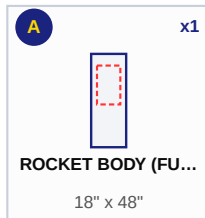
Mission challenge: count down from 10 as a family. On blastoff — EVERYONE jumps!

1

STEP 1: SET UP THE BODY

Tape the top flaps of one tall box closed. Cut the bottom flaps off so the box is open underneath — the astronaut steps in by lifting the rocket over their head. Stand it upright: it should reach about the child's shoulders. The Rocket Body template shows where the cockpit opening goes.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



2

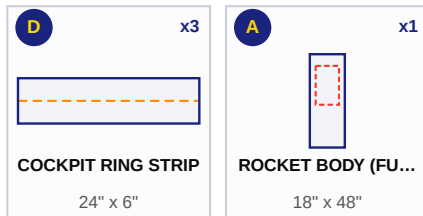
STEP 2: CUT THE COCKPIT OPENING

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

On the front of the rocket body, cut out the arch-topped cockpit opening shown on the template: 12" (30 cm) wide × 20" (51 cm) tall, starting 6" (15 cm) below the top of the box. Have the child stand inside first and check their chest and arms show through it; move it up or down to fit. Then fold each of the 3 Cockpit Ring Strips in half lengthwise (fold mark) and tape them end to end around the cut edge of the opening, folded side outward — they frame the cockpit and cover the raw edge.

SAFETY: Adult cuts the opening only. No sharp inward points on the cut edge.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

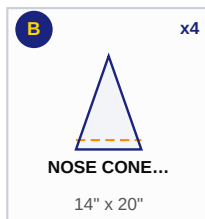


3

STEP 3: BUILD THE NOSE CONE

Cut all 4 Nose Cone Triangles identically (14" (36 cm) base × 20" (51 cm) tall). Take 2 triangles and tape along their matching long edges — fold tabs at the base (mark on template). Add the other 2 the same way. You have a 4-sided pyramid cone. Tape every seam.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



4

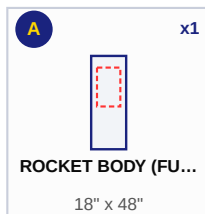
STEP 4: MOUNT THE NOSE CONE

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Place the cone on top of the rocket body. Tape the folded base tabs to all 4 sides of the box top. Reinforce inside the cone at every corner seam.

SAFETY: One person holds cone straight, one tapes. Must be centered or the rocket leans.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

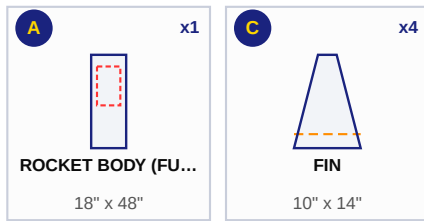


5

STEP 5: ATTACH THE FINS

Each Fin has a fold tab at the base (mark on template). Fold the tab outward. Position 4 fins at 90° intervals around the bottom of the rocket body. Tape each tab firmly to the outside of the box.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

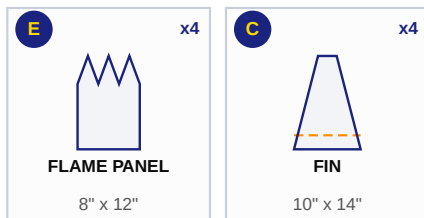


6

STEP 6: ADD FLAMES

Cut the jagged flame top edge on each Flame Panel (mark on template). Attach all 4 Flame Panels at the base between the fins. Paint red at the top, orange in the middle, yellow at the tips. These are the launch flames.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

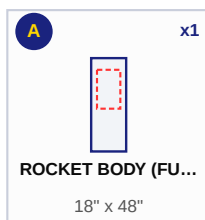


7

STEP 7: PAINT STARS

Draw/paint gold and yellow stars across the entire rocket body. Add a mission name on the side. Add a round porthole near the top.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

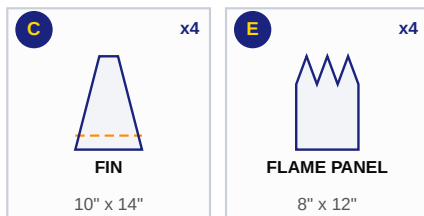


8

STEP 8: QUALITY CHECK

Child steps inside. Fins stable — rocket doesn't tip. Nose cone straight. Flames bold at the base. Stars on the body. Cockpit opening frames the child. Compare to cover photo. That's the standard.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



QUALITY CHECK!

Does your build match the cover photo? Compare side by side before you call it done.

"Build It. Own It." — Tatum & Kash Cardboard Creations